

5.5 Creating And Using Design Templates

Design templates are what give your PowerPoint presentations that sleek professional look. (Quick Reminder: if you're using PowerPoint 2007, go over to chapter 12 for the low-down on Themes, which is the enhanced version of Templates.) In this section, we exclusively look at Design Templates as used in PowerPoint 2003.



This is how to open the Slide Design Task Pane

A design template is, in essence, a slide master that includes a background. The background can be any valid object, including graphics and pictures. Fonts, bullets, logos, colour schemes, and all the formatting options you use in creating your slide master are valid for the design template as well.

PowerPoint comes with a set of existing design templates which you can use or customise to your liking. Although you are offered about 50 preset templates (in PowerPoint 2003), you can create your own Templates if you like. Use the "Design" button to reveal a whole pane full of templates for you to choose from. Or, you could go to Format > Slide Design for the same results.

All you have to do next is left click on the design that really grabs you and immediately all the slides in your presentation will acquire the same background, colour, look and text arrangement of the template you choose.

If you are not satisfied with the available templates, you can go ahead and create your own. Creating your own template may be a better option when you need to create a standardised presentation template to project your personal or your company's identity.